Satya Nadella

Microsoft | Chairman and CEO, since 2014

Meeting: First intro: earn a second meeting | Prepared for: Founder / principal | Depth: standard | Sources: 10 of 12 source types, 18 cited | Status FULL | Prepared Oct 14, 2026

Take. Satya Nadella, Microsoft's Chairman and CEO [1], put knowledge work among his three focus domains [2]; Copilot's 30 million paid seats [3] are a fraction of about 450 million workers [4]. **Evidence:** [2] [3] [4]. **Action:** open on adoption past 30 million seats [3]. **Avoid:** spend-led pitches; he says CapEx talk is "a bug" [5].

QUESTIONS THAT CLOSE GAPS

1. **Autopilot handles recurring work and follow-ups [6]; which meeting tasks does it skip?**
   Decides: whether a prep gap exists. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
2. **Jared Spataro wrote the Copilot launch post [7]; who owns executive use?**
   Decides: the owner for meeting two. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
3. **You build "long-running Foundry agents" [8]; which serve executives' own meetings?**
   Decides: fit with his agent plans. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
4. **How does "Use all, but be independent of all" [9] apply to small tools?**
   Decides: partner or build stance. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.
5. **After April's buyouts [10], what must a tool prove to earn an executive team's time?**
   Decides: the gate. **Ask:** Satya Nadella.

WHO THEY ARE

- **Role:** Chairman and CEO; named CEO in February 2014 [11].
- **Path:** led the Cloud and Enterprise group [12].
- **The organization:** its mission is to empower every person and organization to achieve more [13].
- **What changed:** new Copilot with Autopilot (Sep 25) [14]; buyouts for about 7% of US staff (Apr 23) [10].
- **Recent wins:** Azure up 43%, past $100 billion in a year (Jul 29, 2026) [15].

IN THEIR WORDS

- **On Microsoft's role, All-In, Sep 15, 2026:** "We create technology so that others can create more technology. That's who we are. We're a toolmaker." [16]
- **On focus, Stratechery, Jun 4, 2026:** "I have three domains in which we are going to try and major on: coding, security, and knowledge work." [2]

LinkedIn: not read: file not given

SIGNALS AND WHAT TO DO WITH THEM

OBSERVABLE	WHAT TO DO WITH IT
Copilot has about 30 million users against 450 million knowledge workers [4]	Adoption is the open gap; any route to more daily executive use matters to him now.
Your offer is meeting prep for executive teams [17]	Executives walk into every meeting prepared, with no setup.
Results are due October 28, after the market closes [18]	His attention is on adoption numbers; use it as context, never as pressure.

BEHAVIORAL PROFILE

WHAT THE RECORD SHOWS	YOUR MOVE
Pace and control: names his three focus domains himself [2]	Match their pace; propose once, then ask.
Appetite for detail: cites seat counts and market size [3] [4]	Headline, two proof points, a source on request.
Appetite for risk: "independent of all" while building [9]	Pair the upside with the safeguard in the same sentence.

No read: How they take recognition · How they take disagreement · How they keep score

Evidence tier: medium: it sets how far page 3 goes

WHO DECIDES

- **Decision maker:** Not determined
- **The gate:** Not determined
- **Relationship holder:** Not determined

STRONGEST CASE AGAINST

- **Against:** Microsoft's own Autopilot covers recurring work and follow-ups [6]. **Reverses if:** his team names an executive-prep gap Copilot leaves open.
- **Against:** April's buyouts of about 7% of US staff [10] point to cost scrutiny of new vendors. **Reverses if:** you can count the executive hours saved.

MEETING ANGLE

A. This meeting

- **Frame:** how Microsoft's executives prepare for meetings; not a pitch.
- **Lands:** "Use all, but be independent of all" [9]: you are replaceable.
- **Repels:** spend-led pitches; he called CapEx talk "a bug" [5].
- **What to bring:** a one-page example brief from public sources [17].
- **The ask:** 30 minutes with him or the owner he names [17] · **Fallback:** 15 minutes with Jared Spataro [7].
- **Stop if:** he says Copilot already covers meeting prep.

B. Meeting two

- **Meeting two:** a working session with the Copilot owner on adoption past 30 million seats [3].
- **Meeting three:** a pilot with one executive team.

C. After the meeting

- **Capture:** who he names as owner, and what Copilot leaves out.

EVIDENCE LEDGER

Unmarked facts are measured. 18 facts cited; status FULL at 10 of 12 source types. Dates are the sources' own; 'seen' marks the day an undated source was read.

#	WHAT IT SAYS	SOURCE	GRADE	DATE
[1]	Chairman and Chief Executive Officer of Microsoft	news.microsoft.com	MEASURED	seen Oct 14, 2026
[2]	Three domains: coding, security, knowledge work	stratechery.com	MEASURED	Jun 4, 2026
[3]	Microsoft 365 Copilot passed 30 million paid seats	microsoft.com	MEASURED	Jul 29, 2026
[4]	About 30 million users, 450 million knowledge workers	thefabulous.co	MEASURED	Sep 15, 2026
[5]	Quote: CapEx talk "is not a feature, it's a bug"	thefabulous.co	MEASURED	Sep 15, 2026
[6]	Autopilot works on recurring work and follow-ups	blogs.microsoft.com	MEASURED	Sep 25, 2026
[7]	Jared Spataro wrote the new Copilot launch post	blogs.microsoft.com	MEASURED	Sep 25, 2026
[8]	Quote: building "long-running Foundry agents"	latent.space	MEASURED	Jun 3, 2026
[9]	Quote: "Use all, but be independent of all."	thefabulous.co	MEASURED	Sep 15, 2026
[10]	Buyouts offered to about 7% of US staff	bloomberglaw.com	MEASURED	Apr 23, 2026
[11]	Microsoft named Nadella CEO in February 2014	news.microsoft.com	MEASURED	Feb 4, 2014
[12]	Led Cloud and Enterprise group before CEO	news.microsoft.com	MEASURED	Feb 4, 2014
[13]	Mission: empower every person and organization	microsoft.com	MEASURED	seen Oct 14, 2026
[14]	New Copilot: Home, Code and Autopilot	blogs.microsoft.com	MEASURED	Sep 25, 2026
[15]	Azure revenue up 43%, over $100 billion	microsoft.com	MEASURED	Jul 29, 2026
[16]	Quote: "We're a toolmaker."	thefabulous.co	MEASURED	Sep 15, 2026
[17]	Talyx offer: meeting prep; win is a second meeting	your saved setup	MEASURED	seen Oct 14, 2026
[18]	Q1 FY27 results Oct 28, after market close	news.microsoft.com	MEASURED	Oct 7, 2026

Coverage	10 of 12 source types · Not found: public social posts, register filings · LinkedIn: not read: file not given
Still open	• Decision maker: Who owns executive meeting prep at Microsoft? • The gate: What must a tool prove before executives adopt it? • Relationship holder: Who does he trust to vet outside tools? • How they take disagreement: How would you like pushback raised?
Left out on purpose	health, family, politics, litigation, personal finances
Run	Oct 14, 2026 · standard · first intro · founder / principal · US · FULL · 18 facts cited

MEETING SCRIPT

Facts select the moves; read the room, never the record · Satya Nadella, Microsoft · Prepared Oct 14, 2026

1. OPEN

- **Hook:** *Congratulations on 30 million paid Copilot seats [3]. You named knowledge work one of three domains to major on [2], so I have one question about it.*
- **Credibility:** Talyx builds AI meeting-prep and knowledge tools for executive teams [17].
- **Insight:** Autopilot covers recurring work and follow-ups [6]; preparing before the meeting is not in its description.
- **Rule:** ask one question, then stop; leave the silence after his answer.

2. QUESTION ORDER

- **Story:** You build "long-running Foundry agents" [8]; which serve executives' own meetings?
- **Process:** Jared Spataro wrote the Copilot launch post [7]; who owns executive use?
- **Gate:** After April's buyouts [10], what must a tool prove to earn an executive team's time?
- **History:** How does "Use all, but be independent of all" [9] apply to small tools?
- **Commitment:** Autopilot handles recurring work and follow-ups [6]; which meeting tasks does it skip?

3. OBJECTIONS: NAME IT, THEN ANSWER

- **"Copilot already does this.":** *Autopilot covers follow-ups [6]; which meeting tasks does it skip?*
- **"No time for another vendor.":** *April's buyouts [10] show cost care; I ask for 30 minutes, nothing more.*
- **"We build, we do not buy.":** *You said "Use all, but be independent of all" [9]; I am a replaceable tool, not a dependency.*

4. CLOSE

- **Restate:** ask what would make 30 more minutes an easy yes, then say it back in his words.
- **Real deadline:** nothing of his forces a date; his October 28 results [18] are the next fixed point, so offer a slot after it.
- **The ask:** a second 30-minute meeting [17] · **Fallback:** 15 minutes with Jared Spataro [7].
- **Follow-up:** send the one-page example within one day.

5. READ THE ROOM (WATCH, DO NOT ASSUME)

- **Fast, wants the answer:** match his pace; propose once, then ask [2].
- **Asks for terms and data:** headline, two proof points, a source on request [3].
- **Talks about people:** no read; ask who else weighs in.
- **Big picture, ideas:** pair the upside with the safeguard in the same sentence [9].

6. IF IT STALLS

- **The move:** ask which Autopilot gap matters most [6].
- **The move:** return to 30 million seats against 450 million workers [4].

7. GUARDRAILS

- **Rule:** in the US, promise no results from Microsoft's products; claim only what the public record shows.
- **Never say:** "Does that make sense?" · "Is this helpful?" · "No pressure" · "You'd know better than me" · "Just checking in"

Next step: send the one-page example on Oct 17, 2026 [17].